Gmail

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Newsletter for Beyond the Bend Yoga

1 message

Laura Harvey <laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca> Sun, Jul 20, 2025 at 11:36 PM
Reply-To: Laura Harvey <Q1Dj9Ty80KPEYqdYHF7N-smtpreply@mg.msgsndr.us>
To: coachlharvey@gmail.com

Hi Laura

For the past few weeks, I've been steadily and thoughtfully preparing for the upcoming Root & Bloom workshop - shaping the yoga flow, collaborating with Tamara on the creative elements, and envisioning the energy of the people who will gather in that space. It's been such a grounding process, reminding me of the beauty in slowing down and creating something intentional.

Whether or not you're joining us this time, I hope today's reflection offers a small pause—a moment to root in and reconnect.

With warmth and gratitude,
Laura

This Week's Wellness Wisdom

This Week’s Wellness Wisdom

The Sacred Power of Slowing Down:
A nervous system reset for women in their prime years

By Laura Harvey | Beyond the Bend Yoga

“You should sit in meditation for twenty minutes a day. Unless you are too busy - then you should sit for an hour.” Zen proverb

If you’re like most women I work with, you’ve been moving at high speed for decades.

Juggling schedules. Supporting others. Reinventing yourself.
Even your healing journey might feel... rushed.

But what if the very thing you’ve been told to push through - your fatigue, your brain fog, your emotional sensitivity - isn’t something to fix?

What if it’s your body asking you to slow down… so it can finally exhale?

Why Slowness Feels So Unfamiliar

Maybe you’ve tried resting, only to feel restless.
Maybe silence makes you squirm.
Maybe “doing nothing” feels like failure.

It’s not just you.

Many of us learned early that our worth was tied to our output.
We were praised for being strong. Quiet. Self-sufficient. Helpful.
So we became efficient. Focused. Always on.

But underneath that hustle is a nervous system in overdrive - bracing, micromanaging, surviving.

And when your nervous system is in survival mode, rest doesn't feel safe. It feels like a threat.

The Midlife Reframe

Menopause and perimenopause can be disorienting. Your body changes. Your energy shifts. The things that used to work - don't.
And no one hands you a roadmap.

But what if this season of life isn't a breakdown… but a sacred pause?

A moment where your body says:
Enough.
Enough pushing. Enough pretending. Enough overriding your own needs.

This isn't weakness. It's wisdom.

Midlife is not the time to hustle harder.
It's the time to soften. To listen. To reconnect with your own rhythm.

The Strength of Softness

You don't need another protocol or productivity hack.
You need more space. More breath. More grace.

Slowness isn't quitting.
It's a different kind of power, the kind that trusts your body to lead.
The kind that honors your inner knowing instead of external expectations.

To slow down is not to fall behind.
It's to step fully into your own pace.

Try This

Here are a few gentle invitations to begin resetting your nervous system:

- 🌿 Take one breath and simply notice it - no fixing, no deepening. Just notice.
- 🌿 Pause before reacting. Let your body speak first.
- 🌿 Do one ordinary task at half-speed - just to feel how that lands.
- 🌿 Lie down for three minutes. No music. No goals. Just a quiet gift to yourself.

Your nervous system doesn't need you to "do it right."
It needs to know it's safe to rest. Safe to feel. Safe to just be.

And that safety?
It starts with giving yourself permission to slow down.

Right here.
Right now.
No apology required.

Check out Fall Classes

Root and Bloom:
A creative pause for individuals ready to exhale deeply and express soulfully.

Root & Bloom is just one week away!

I've poured so much love into this experience, and I'd be honored to share it with you. If you've been feeling the pull to slow down, reconnect, and create something just for *you* - this is your invitation.

Spaces are limited, and there's still time to join us. All the details are below.

Presented by:
Beyond the Bend + Creative Spark

Date: Sunday, July 27, 2025

Time:
Check-in: 12:30 PM
Workshop: 1:00 PM – 6:00 PM

Location:
Integrity Seminars Studio
14920 Stony Plain Road
Edmonton, AB

Join us for a unique 5-hour workshop that blends somatic and restorative yoga, breathwork, meditation, and journaling with a guided mandala art session.

Root & Bloom is designed as a creative pause—a space to slow down, exhale deeply, and express soulfully.

You'll be guided through yoga movement and reflection practices to calm your nervous system, followed by a relaxing tea break and an opportunity to explore your inner world through mandala creation.

No yoga or art experience needed—just come as you are.

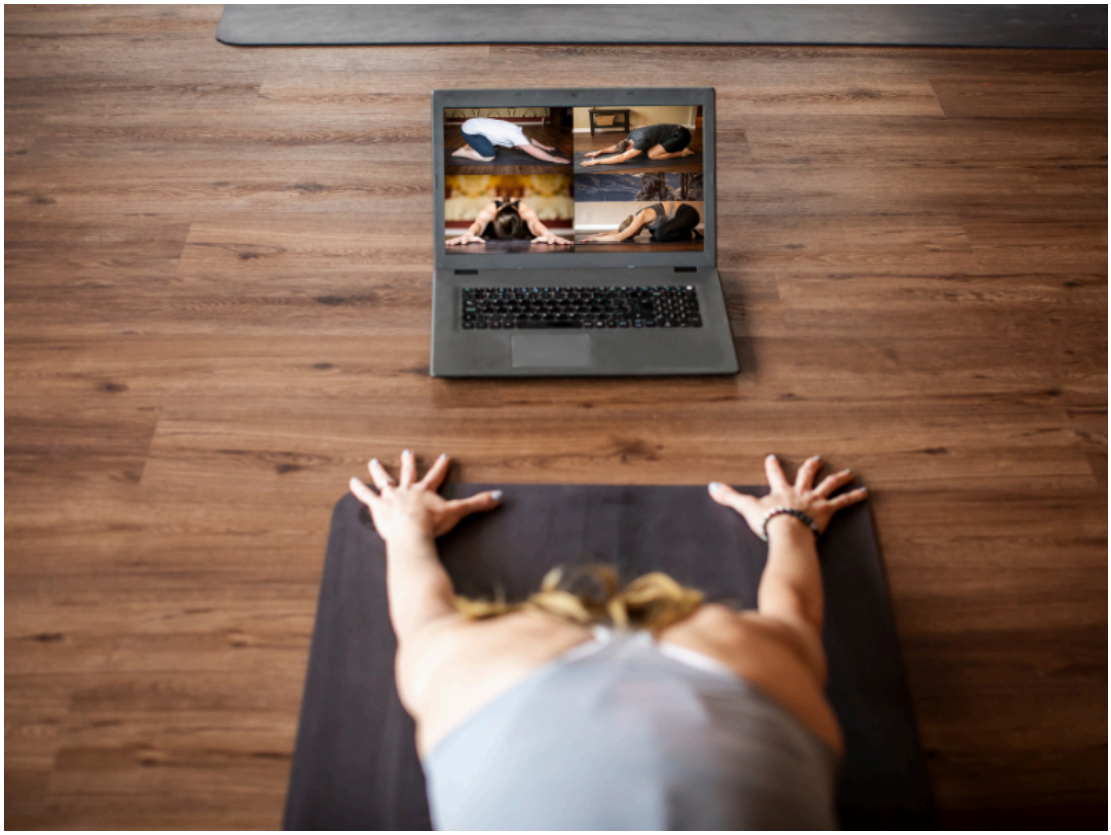
SAVE MY SPOT NOW

Private 1:1 Restorative Yoga

Looking for a deeper level of support?
These personalized sessions are designed to meet you exactly where you are — body, mind, and spirit. Whether you're holding tension, moving through a life transition, or simply craving stillness, this is a space to exhale and reconnect with yourself.

Held online with Laura Harvey, experienced yoga teacher with over 20 years of practice in mindful, healing movement.

🔗 [Book a Private Session]



SIGN UP TODAY

Stillness Skill:
The Meditative Walk

This week's Stillness Skill is an invitation to walk with intention—and let your body become your meditation cushion.

Begin by standing still. Let your face soften. Unclench your jaw. Lower your shoulders. Feel your feet firmly planted on the ground.

As you start to walk, slow your pace. Let it feel almost exaggerated, as if you're savoring each step.

Notice how your weight shifts:
• Heel to arch
• Arch to ball
• Ball to toes
• One foot lifting, the other settling

Feel the earth beneath you. Let your arms swing naturally. Let your breath be easy.

If your mind feels busy or restless, introduce a simple mantra in rhythm with your steps.

Try:
• *“Here.” (step) “Now.” (step)*
• or *“I am.” (step) “At peace.” (step)*

Whisper it softly, or just repeat it silently in your mind.

Let the mantra be your thread back to presence each time the mind pulls away. There’s no need to fight the thoughts—just gently return.

You don’t need a destination. The walk *is* the practice.

Our e-mail address is:
laura@beyondthebendyoga.ca

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